

Interest Statement

Children and Youth in Conflict Analyst | Piter Garcia

I am applying for Babel Institute's Children and Youth in Conflict Analyst role because it joins research, public writing, education, and advocacy for young people whose experiences are too often interpreted without their voices. As a Dominican American, data scientist, and K-12 computer science teacher candidate, I have learned to move between technical evidence, educational practice, and lived experience while writing for readers with different backgrounds.

My teaching and research focus on access, language, disability, neurodivergence, chronic illness, and the institutional conditions that shape whether young people can participate with dignity. In elementary computer science and environmental-science settings, I have designed inclusive activities, listened for what students communicate through participation and behavior, and revised instruction around their needs. My graduate research has also trained me to document sources carefully, test claims, and explain complex systems clearly.

At Babel, I would bring that same evidence-grounded and human-centered approach to research on education during conflict, displacement, child protection, and youth participation. I am especially interested in producing accessible work that connects policy evidence with young people's experiences, responds seriously to editorial feedback, and helps general audiences understand both institutional failures and possibilities for change.